

Art & Culture — UPSC Prelims PYQ

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— 2026 —

UPSC 2026

Art & Culture › Sculpture & Iconography

moderate

Q2. What does an empty seat represent in early Buddhist iconography ?

- (a) The meditation of the Buddha**
- (b) The Buddha's First Sermon
- (c) The Buddha's Mahaparinibbana
- (d) The Buddha's Mahabhinishkramana

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2026

Art & Culture › Sculpture & Iconography

moderate

Q4. Which of the following statements on the Amaravati Stupa and its relief sculpture is/are correct ?

1. It was located in the lower Krishna valley.
2. In India, it was next only to the Sanchi Stupa in size.
3. The Amaravati school of sculpture made a lasting impact on the later South Indian sculpture, and its products were carried to Sri Lanka and South-east Asia.

Select the answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only**
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2026

Art & Culture › Music

difficult

Q9. Pandit Mallikarjun Mansur, the famous classical singer from Karnataka, represented the :

- (a) Agra Gharana
- (b) Gwalior Gharana
- (c) Patiala Gharana
- (d) Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2026

Art & Culture › Music

difficult

Q11. Which one of the following Carnatic music ragas is similar to Raga Bilawal in Hindustani music ?

- (a) Nat Bhairavi
- (b) Kamavardhini
- (c) Hanumatodi
- (d) Dheera Shankarabharanam**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2026

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q14. Which of the following temples has/have a Nagara-style shikhara ?

1. Malegitti Shivalaya, Badami
2. Huchimalligudi Temple, Aihole
3. Dashavatara Temple, Deogarh
4. Virupaksha Temple, Pattadakal

Select the answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3**
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2026

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

moderate

Q15. Among the four main forms of existence of life recognized in Jainism, which one of the following is not included ?

- (a) Deva (gods)
- (b) Yaksha (demi-gods)**
- (c) Manushya (humans)
- (d) Tiryancha (animals and plants)

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2026

Art & Culture › Painting & Visual Arts

difficult

Q16. The Hallisalasya painting in the Bagh Caves represents :

- (a) A joyous folk dance**
- (b) Buddha in a meditative pose
- (c) The depiction of Shiva and Parvati on Kailasha
- (d) Samudramanathan (Churning of the Ocean)

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2026

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q27. Which one of the following statements with regard to the Moidams, built by the Tai-Ahom kingdom and inscribed as a World Heritage Site by UNESCO, is/are correct ?

1. They acted as army fortresses.
2. They were recreation centres of the Royals and Nobles.
3. They were burial grounds of the Royals and Nobles.
4. They were battle drill centres of the Royals and Nobles.

Select the answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 3
- (c) 3 only**
- (d) 2 and 4

Answer: (c)

— 2025 —

UPSC 2025

Art & Culture › Music

easy

Q18. The first Gandharva Mahavidyalaya, a music training school, was set up in 1901 by Vishnu Digambar Paluskar in

- (a) Delhi
- (b) Gwalior
- (c) Ujjain
- (d) Lahore**

Answer: (d)

— 2024 —

UPSC 2024

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q54. With reference to ancient India, Gautama Buddha was generally known by which of the following epithets ?

1. Nayaputta
2. Shakyamuni
3. Tathagata

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None of the above are epithets of Gautama Buddha

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2024

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q58. Consider the following statements :

- 1. There are no parables in Upanishads.**
 - 2. Upanishads were composed earlier than the Puranas.**
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2024

Art & Culture › Cultural Institutions & Awards

moderate

Q60. Which one of the following was the latest inclusion in the Intangible Cultural Heritage List of UNESCO ?

- (a) Chhau dance
- (b) Durga puja
- (c) Garba dance**
- (d) Kumbh mela

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2024

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q63. Which one of the following is a work attributed to playwright Bhasa ?

- (a) Kavyalankara
- (b) Natyashastra
- (c) Madhyama-vyayoga**
- (d) Mahabhashya

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2024

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

difficult

Q64. Sanghabhuti, an Indian Buddhist monk, who travelled to China at the end of the fourth century AD, was the author of a commentary on :

- (a) Prajnaparamita Sutra
- (b) Visuddhimagga
- (c) Sarvastivada Vinaya**
- (d) Lalitavistara

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2024

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q65. Consider the following properties included in the World Heritage List released by UNESCO :

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.

How many of the above properties were included in 2023 ?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two**
- (c) Only three
- (d) All four

Answer: (b)

— 2023 —

UPSC 2023

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q41. In which one of the following regions was Dhanyakataka, which flourished as a prominent Buddhist centre under the Mahasanghikas, located?

- (a) Andhra**
- (b) Gandhara
- (c) Kalinga
- (d) Magadha

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2023

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

moderate

Q44. Which one of the following explains the practice of 'Vattakirutal' as mentioned in Sangam poems?

- (a) Kings employing women bodyguards
- (b) Learned persons assembling in royal courts to discuss religious and philosophical matters
- (c) Young girls keeping watch over agricultural fields and driving away birds and animals
- (d) A king defeated in a battle committing ritual suicide by starving himself to death**

Answer: (d)

Q46. With reference to ancient Indian History, consider the following pairs :

Literary work : Author

- 1. Devichandragupta : Bilhana**
- 2. Hammira-Mahakavya : Nayachandra Suri**
- 3. Milinda-panha : Nagarjuna**
- 4. Nitivakyamrita : Somadeva Suri**

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two**
- (c) Only three
- (d) All four

Answer: (b)

Q47. "Souls are not only the property of animal and plant life, but also of rocks, running water and many other natural objects not looked on as living by other religious sects."

The above statement reflects one of the core beliefs of which one of the following religious sects of ancient India?

- (a) Buddhism
- (b) Jainism**
- (c) Shaivism
- (d) Vaishnavism

Answer: (b)

Q81. With reference to the Indian History, Alexander Rea, A. H. Longhurst, Robert Sewell, James Burgess and Walter Elliot were associated with

- (a) archaeological excavations**
- (b) establishment of English Press in Colonial India
- (c) establishment of Churches in Princely States
- (d) construction of railways in Colonial India

Answer: (a)

Q82. Consider the following pairs :

Site Well known for

1. Besnagar : Shaivite cave shrine
2. Bhaja : Buddhist cave shrine
3. Sittanavasal : Jain cave shrine

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two**
- (c) All three
- (d) None

Answer: (b)

— 2022 —

Q55. With reference to Indian history, consider the following texts :

1. Nettipakarana
 2. Parishishtaparvan
 3. Avadanashataka
 4. Trishashtilakshana Mahapurana
- Which of the above are Jaina texts ?**

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
- (b) 2 and 4 only**
- (c) 1, 3 and 4
- (d) 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

Q56. With reference to Indian history, consider the following pairs :

Historical person

1. Aryadeva — Jaina scholar
2. Dignaga — Buddhist scholar
3. Nathamuni — Vaishnava scholar

How many pairs given above are correctly matched ?

- (a) None of the pairs
- (b) Only one pair
- (c) Only two pairs**
- (d) All three pairs

Answer: (c)

Q93. Which one of the following statements about Sangam literature in ancient South India is correct ?

- (a) Sangam poems are devoid of any reference to material culture.
- (b) The social classification of Varna was known to Sangam poets.**
- (c) Sangam poems have no reference to warrior ethic.
- (d) Sangam literature refers to magical forces as irrational.

Answer: (b)

Q96. The Prime Minister recently inaugurated the new Circuit House near Somnath Temple at Veraval. Which of the following statements are correct regarding Somnath Temple ?

- 1. Somnath Temple is one of the Jyotirlinga shrines.
- 2. A description of Somnath Temple was given by Al-Biruni.
- 3. Pran Pratishtha of Somnath Temple (installation of the present day temple) was done by President S. Radhakrishnan.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only**
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

— 2021 —

Q31. With reference to Chausath Yogini Temple situated near Morena, consider the following statements :

- 1. It is a circular temple built during the reign of Kachchhapaghata Dynasty.
- 2. It is the only circular temple built in India.
- 3. It was meant to promote the Vaishnava cult in the region.
- 4. Its design has given rise to a popular belief that it was the inspiration behind the Indian Parliament building.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 4**
- (d) 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2021

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

moderate

Q39. Consider the following statements :

- 1. St. Francis Xavier was one of the founding members of the Jesuit Order.**
- 2. St. Francis Xavier died in Goa and a church is dedicated to him there.**
- 3. The Feast of St. Francis Xavier is celebrated in Goa each year.**

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2021

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q41. With reference to the history of ancient India, Bhavabhuti, Hastimalla and Kshemeshvara were famous

- (a) Jain monks
- (b) playwrights**
- (c) temple architects
- (d) philosophers

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2021

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q49. Which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) Ajanta Caves lie in the gorge of Waghora river.**
- (b) Sanchi Stupa lies in the gorge of Chambal river.
- (c) Pandu-lena Cave Shrines lie in the gorge of Narmada river.
- (d) Amaravati Stupa lies in the gorge of Godavari river.

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2021

Art & Culture › Music

moderate

Q95. With reference to India, the terms 'Halbi, Ho and Kui' pertain to

- (a) dance forms of Northwest India
- (b) musical instruments
- (c) pre-historic cave paintings
- (d) tribal languages**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2020

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

moderate

Q31. With reference to the cultural history of India, which one of the following is the correct description of the term 'paramitas' ?

- (a) The earliest Dharmashastra texts written in aphoristic (sutra) style
- (b) Philosophical schools that did not accept the authority of Vedas
- (c) Perfections whose attainment led to the Bodhisattva path**
- (d) Powerful merchant guilds of early medieval South India

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2020

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

moderate

Q36. With reference to the scholars/litterateurs of ancient India, consider the following statements :

- 1. Panini is associated with Pushyamitra Shunga.**
 - 2. Amarasimha is associated with Harshavardhana.**
 - 3. Kalidasa is associated with Chandra Gupta – II.**
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?**

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

— 2019 —

UPSC 2019

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q9. Consider the following :

- 1. Deification of the Buddha**
- 2. Treading the path of Bodhisattvas**
- 3. Image worship and rituals**

Which of the above is/are the feature/features of Mahayana Buddhism?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2019

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q11. Building 'Kalyaana Mandapas' was a notable feature in the temple construction in the kingdom of

- (a) Chalukya
- (b) Chandela
- (c) Rashtrakuta
- (d) Vijayanagara**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2019

Art & Culture › Music

moderate

Q16. With reference to Mian Tansen, which one of the following statements is not correct?

- (a) Tansen was the title given to him by Emperor Akbar.**
- (b) Tansen composed Dhrupads on Hindu gods and goddesses.
- (c) Tansen composed songs on his patrons.
- (d) Tansen invented many Ragas.

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2019

Art & Culture › Music

easy

Q17. Who among the following Mughal Emperors shifted emphasis from illustrated manuscripts to album and individual portrait?

- (a) Humayun
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Jahangir**
- (d) Shah Jahan

Answer: (c)

— 2018 —

UPSC 2018

Art & Culture › Festivals, Crafts & Folk Traditions

moderate

Q22. Consider the following pairs :

Tradition — State

- 1. Chapchar Kut festival — Mizoram**
- 2. Khongjom Parba ballad — Manipur**
- 3. Thang-Ta dance — Sikkim**

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2**
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2018

Art & Culture › Painting & Visual Arts

easy

Q42. The well-known painting "Bani Thani" belongs to the

- (a) Bundi school
- (b) Jaipur school
- (c) Kangra school
- (d) Kishangarh school**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2018

Art & Culture › Music

difficult

Q44. With reference to cultural history of India, consider the following statements :

1. Most of the Tyagaraja Kritis are devotional songs in praise of Lord Krishna.
 2. Tyagaraja created several new ragas.
 3. Annamacharya and Tyagaraja are contemporaries.
 4. Annamacharya kirtanas are devotional songs in praise of Lord Venkateshwara.
- Which of the statements given above are correct ?**

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 and 4 only**
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2018

Art & Culture › Festivals, Crafts & Folk Traditions

moderate

Q54. Consider the following pairs :

Craft Heritage of

1. Puthukkuli shawls — Tamil Nadu
2. Sujni embroidery — Maharashtra
3. Uppada Jamdani saris — Karnataka

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 1 and 2
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2018

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q71. With reference to the religious practices in India, the "Sthanakvasi" sect belongs to

- (a) Buddhism
- (b) Jainism**
- (c) Vaishnavism
- (d) Shaivism

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2018

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q72. With reference to the cultural history of India, consider the following statements :

- 1.
- 2.

Lucknow.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2018

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q74. With reference to Indian history, who among the following is a future Buddha, yet to come to save the world ?

- (a) Avalokiteshvara
- (b) Lokeshvara
- (c) Maitreya**
- (d) Padmapani

Answer: (c)

— 2017 —

UPSC 2017

Art & Culture › Music

moderate

Q18. The term 'Digital Single Market Strategy' seen in the news refers to

- (a) ASEAN
- (b) BRICS
- (c) EU**
- (d) G20

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2017

Art & Culture › Painting & Visual Arts

easy

Q69. The painting of Bodhisattva Padmapani is one of the most famous and oft-illustrated paintings at

- (a) Ajanta**
- (b) Badami
- (c) Bagh
- (d) Ellora

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2017

Art & Culture › Festivals, Crafts & Folk Traditions

moderate

Q70. Consider the following pairs :
Traditions Communities

1. Chaliha Sahib Festival – Sindhis
2. Nanda Raj Jaat Yatra – Gonds
3. Wari-Warkari – Santhals

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched ?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) None of the above

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2017

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q75. Which of the following is/are famous for Sun temples ?

1. Arasavalli
2. Amarakantak
3. Omkareshwar

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

— 2016 —

UPSC 2016

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

moderate

Q10. Which one of the following books of ancient India has the love story of the son of the founder of Sunga dynasty?

- (a) Swapnavasavadatta
- (b) Malavikagnimitra**
- (c) Meghadoota
- (d) Ratnavali

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2016

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

moderate

Q50. With reference to the religious history of India, consider the following statements :

- 1. The concept of Bodhisattva is central to Hinayana sect of Buddhism.**
 - 2. Bodhisattva is a compassionate one on his way to enlightenment.**
 - 3. Bodhisattva delays achieving his own salvation to help all sentient beings on their path to it.**
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 2 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2016

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q65. What is/are common to the two historical places known as Ajanta and Mahabalipuram?

- 1. Both were built in the same period.**
 - 2. Both belong to the same religious denomination.**
 - 3. Both have rock-cut monuments.**
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.**

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only**
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) None of the statements given above is correct

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2016

Art & Culture › Festivals, Crafts & Folk Traditions

moderate

Q89. With reference to the cultural history of India, the memorizing of chronicles, dynastic histories and epic tales was the profession of who of the following?

- (a) Shramana
- (b) Parivraajaka**
- (c) Agrahaarika
- (d) Maagadha

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2016

Art & Culture › Theatre & Cinema

easy

Q99. A recent movie titled The Man Who Knew Infinity is based on the biography of

- (a) S. Ramanujan**
- (b) S. Chandrasekhar
- (c) S. N. Bose
- (d) C. V. Raman

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2015

Art & Culture › Sculpture & Iconography

moderate

Q54. With reference to the art and archaeological history of India, which one among the following was made earliest?

- (a) Lingaraja Temple at Bhubaneswar
- (b) Rock-cut Elephant at Dhauli**
- (c) Rock-cut Monuments at Mahabalipuram
- (d) Varaha Image at Udayagiri

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2015

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q75. Which one of the following was given classical language status recently?

- (a) Odia**
- (b) Konkani
- (c) Bhojpuri
- (d) Assamese

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2015

Art & Culture › Festivals, Crafts & Folk Traditions

easy

Q96. Kalamkari painting refers to

- (a) a hand-painted cotton textile in South India**
- (b) a handmade drawing on bamboo handicrafts in North-East India
- (c) a block-painted woollen cloth in Western Himalayan region of India
- (d) a hand-painted decorative silk cloth in North-Western India

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2015

Art & Culture › Festivals, Crafts & Folk Traditions

moderate

Q99. Which of the following has/have been accorded 'Geographical Indication' status?

1. Banaras Brocades and Sarees
2. Rajasthani Daal-Bati-Churma
3. Tirupathi Laddu

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2014

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q8. Consider the following languages :

1. Gujarati
2. Kannada
3. Telugu

Which of the above has/have been declared as 'Classical Language/Languages' by the Government?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2014

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q44. With reference to the cultural history of India, the term 'Panchayatan' refers to

- (a) an assembly of village elders
- (b) a religious sect
- (c) a style of temple construction**
- (d) an administrative functionary

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2014

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q47. Which one of the following pairs does not form part of the six systems of Indian Philosophy?

- (a) Mimamsa and Vedanta
- (b) Nyaya and Vaisheshika
- (c) Lokayata and Kapalika**
- (d) Sankhya and Yoga

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2014

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q54. The national motto of India, 'Satyameva Jayate' inscribed below the Emblem of India is taken from

- (a) Katha Upanishad
- (b) Chandogya Upanishad
- (c) Aitareya Upanishad
- (d) Mundaka Upanishad**

Answer: (d)

Q76. Consider the following towns of India :

1. Bhadrachalam
2. Chanderi
3. Kancheepuram
4. Karnal

Which of the above are famous for the production of traditional sarees/fabric?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) 1, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

Q83. With reference to the famous Sattriya dance, consider the following statements :

1. Sattriya is a combination of music, dance and drama.
2. It is a centuries-old living tradition of Vaishnavites of Assam.
3. It is based on classical Ragas and Talas of devotional songs composed by Tulsidas, Kabir and Mirabai.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only**
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q84. Chaitra 1 of the national calendar based on the Saka Era corresponds to which one of the following dates of the Gregorian calendar in a normal year of 365 days?

- (a) 22nd March (or 21st March)**
- (b) 15th May (or 16th May)
- (c) 31st March (or 30th March)
- (d) 21st April (or 20th April)

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2014

Art & Culture › Sculpture & Iconography

moderate

**Q85. With reference to the Indian history of art and culture, consider the following pairs :
Famous work of sculpture**

1. A grand image of Buddha's Mahaparinirvana with numerous celestial musicians above and the sorrowful figures of his followers below : Ajanta
2. A huge image of Varaha Avatar (boar incarnation) of Vishnu, as he rescues Goddess Earth from the deep and chaotic waters, sculpted on rock : Mount Abu
3. "Arjuna's Penance"/"Descent of Ganga" sculpted on the surface of huge boulders : Mamallapuram

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2014

Art & Culture › Festivals, Crafts & Folk Traditions

easy

Q87. With reference to India's culture and tradition, what is 'Kalaripayattu'?

- (a) It is an ancient Bhakti cult of Shaivism still prevalent in some parts of South India
- (b) It is an ancient style bronze and brasswork still found in southern part of Coromandel area
- (c) It is an ancient form of dance-drama and a living tradition in the northern part of Malabar
- (d) It is an ancient martial art and a living tradition in some parts of South India**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2014

Art & Culture › Classical Dance Forms

easy

Q88. Consider the following pairs :

1. Garba : Gujarat
2. Mohiniattam : Odisha
3. Yakshagana : Karnataka

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2014

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q89. With reference to Buddhist history, tradition and culture in India, consider the following pairs :

Famous shrine

1. Tabo monastery and temple complex : Spiti Valley
2. Lhotsava Lhakhang temple, Nako : Zaskar Valley
3. Alchi temple complex : Ladakh

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2014

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

moderate

Q90. Consider the following statements :

1. 'Bijak' is a composition of the teachings of Saint Dadu Dayal.
2. The Philosophy of Pushti Marg was propounded by Madhvacharya.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2014

Art & Culture › Music

easy

Q91. A community of people called Manganiyars is well-known for their

- (a) martial arts in North-East India
- (b) musical tradition in North-West India**
- (c) classical vocal music in South India
- (d) pietra dura tradition in Central India

Answer: (b)

— 2013 —

Q4. With reference to the history of Indian rock-cut architecture, consider the following statements:

1. The caves at Badami are the oldest surviving rock-cut caves in India.
2. The Barabar rock-cut caves were originally made for Ajivikas by Emperor Chandragupta Maurya.
3. At Ellora, caves were made for different faiths.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q36. Some Buddhist rock-cut caves are called Chaityas, while the others are called Viharas. What is the difference between the two?

- (a) Vihara is a place of worship, while Chaitya is the dwelling place of the monks
- (b) Chaitya is a place of worship, while Vihara is the dwelling place of the monks**
- (c) Chaitya is the stupa at the far end of the cave, while Vihara is the hall axial to it
- (d) There is no material difference between the two

Answer: (b)

Q37. Which one of the following describes best the concept of Nirvana in Buddhism?

- (a) The extinction of the flame of desire**
- (b) The complete annihilation of self
- (c) A state of bliss and rest
- (d) A mental stage beyond all comprehension

Answer: (a)

Q47. Which of the following statements is/are applicable to Jain doctrine?

1. The surest way of annihilating Karma is to practice penance.
2. Every object, even the smallest particle, has a soul.
3. Karma is the bane of the soul and must be ended.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q57. Consider the following historical places :

1. Ajanta Caves
2. Lepakshi Temple
3. Sanchi Stupa

Which of the above places is/are also known for mural paintings?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only**
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None

Answer: (b)

Q58. With reference to the history of philosophical thought in India, consider the following statements regarding Sankhya school :

1. Sankhya does not accept the theory of rebirth or transmigration of soul.
2. Sankhya holds that it is the self-knowledge that leads to liberation and not any exterior influence or agent.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

Q73. Consider the following pairs: Tribe State

1. Limboo (Limbu) : Sikkim

2. Karbi : Himachal Pradesh

3. Dongaria Kondh : Odisha

4. Bonda : Tamil Nadu

Which of the above pairs are correctly matched?

(a) 1 and 3 only

(b) 2 and 4 only

(c) 1, 3 and 4 only

(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a)

Q79. In the context of cultural history of India, a pose in dance and dramatics called 'Tribhanga' has been a favourite of Indian artists from ancient times till today.

Which one of the following statements best describes this pose?

(a) One leg is bent and the body is slightly but oppositely curved at waist and neck

(b) Facial expressions, hand gestures and make-up are combined to symbolize certain epic or historic characters

(c) Movements of body, face and hands are used to express oneself or to tell a story

(d) A little smile, slightly curved waist and certain hand gestures are emphasized to express the feelings of love or eroticism

Answer: (a)

— 2012 —

Q24. The Nagara, the Dravida and the Vesara are the

(a) three main racial groups of the Indian subcontinent

(b) three main linguistic divisions into which the languages of India can be classified

(c) three main styles of Indian temple architecture

(d) three main musical Gharanas prevalent in India

Answer: (c)

Q67. With reference to Dhrupad, one of the major traditions of India that has been kept alive for centuries, which of the following statements are correct?

1. Dhrupad originated and developed in the Rajput kingdoms during the Mughal period.
2. Dhrupad is primarily a devotional and spiritual music.
3. Dhrupad Alap uses Sanskrit syllables from Mantras.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None of the above is correct

Answer: (b)

Q68. How do you distinguish between Kuchipudi and Bharatanatyam dances?

1. Dancers occasionally speaking dialogues is found in Kuchipudi dance but not in Bharatanatyam.
2. Dancing on the brass plate by keeping the feet on its edges is a feature of Bharatanatyam but Kuchipudi dance does not have such a form of movements.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

Q72. Lord Buddha's image is sometimes shown with the hand gesture called 'Bhumisparsha Mudra'. It symbolizes

- (a) Buddha's calling of the Earth to watch over Māra and to prevent Māra from disturbing his meditation
- (b) Buddha's calling of the Earth to witness his purity and chastity despite the temptations of Māra**
- (c) Buddha's reminder to his followers that they all arise from the Earth and finally dissolve into the Earth, and thus this life is transitory
- (d) Both the statements (a) and (b) are correct in this context

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2011

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q77. The Jain philosophy holds that the world is created and maintained by

- (a) Universal Law**
- (b) Universal Truth
- (c) Universal Faith
- (d) Universal Soul

Answer: (a)

— 2010 —

UPSC 2010

Art & Culture › Painting & Visual Arts

easy

Q55. There are only two known examples of cave paintings of the Gupta period in ancient India. One of these is paintings of Ajanta caves. Where is the other surviving example of Gupta paintings?

- (a) Bagh caves**
- (b) Ellora caves
- (c) Lomas Rishi cave
- (d) Nasik caves

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2010

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q120. Among the following, who was not a proponent of bhakti cult ?

- (a) Nagarjuna**
- (b) Tukaram
- (c) Tyagaraja
- (d) Vallabhacharya

Answer: (a)

— 2009 —

UPSC 2009

Art & Culture › Music

easy

Q12. The brothers Umakant and Ramakant Gundecha are

- (a) Dhrupad vocalists**
- (b) Kathak dancers
- (c) Sarod maestros
- (d) Tabla players

Answer: (a)

Q13. Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List I (Famous person)

- A. Mandakini Amte**
- B. Neelam Mansingh Chowdhry**
- C. Romila Thapar**
- D. Vanashree Rao**

List II (Well-known for)

- 1. Theatre direction**
- 2. Social service and community leadership**
- 3. Dance**
- 4. History writing**

(a) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3

(b) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3

(c) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2

(d) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2

Answer: (a)

Q15. In which State is the Buddhist site Tabo Monastery located?

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh
- (b) Himachal Pradesh**
- (c) Sikkim
- (d) Uttarakhand

Answer: (b)

Q17. Mahamasthakabhisheka, a great religious event, is associated with and done for who of the following?

- (a) Bahubali**
- (b) Buddha
- (c) Mahavir
- (d) Nataraja

Answer: (a)

Q18. Consider the following pairs:

Tradition — State

1. Gatka, a traditional martial art : Kerala
2. Madhubani, a traditional painting : Bihar
3. Singhye Khababs Sindhu Darshan Festival : Jammu and Kashmir

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q20. Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List I (Famous person)

- A. Amrita Sher-Gil**
- B. Bhimsen Joshi**
- C. Rukmini Devi Arundale**
- D. Suryakant Tripathi Nirala**

List II (Well-known as)

- 1. Dancer**
- 2. Painter**
- 3. Poet**
- 4. Singer**

- (a) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3
- (b) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3**
- (c) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2
- (d) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2009

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q23. Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List I (Book)

- A. In Custody**
- B. Sea of Poppies**
- C. The Argumentative Indian**
- D. Unaccustomed Earth**

List II (Author)

- 1. Amartya Sen**
- 2. Amitav Ghosh**
- 3. Anita Desai**
- 4. Jhumpa Lahiri**

- (a) A-4 B-1 C-2 D-3
- (b) A-4 B-2 C-1 D-3
- (c) A-3 B-2 C-1 D-4**
- (d) A-3 B-1 C-2 D-4

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2009

Art & Culture › Tribes & Communities

moderate

Q24. Among the following, who are the Agaria community ?

- (a) A traditional toddy tappers community of Andhra Pradesh
- (b) A traditional fishing community of Maharashtra
- (c) A traditional silk-weaving community of Karnataka
- (d) A traditional salt pan workers community of Gujarat**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2009

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q25. Recently,

which one of the following was included in the UNESCO's World Heritage list ?

- (a) Dilwara Temple
- (b) Kalka-Shimla Railway**
- (c) Bhitarkanika Mangrove Area
- (d) Visakhapatnam to Araku valley railway line

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2009

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q26. Where is the famous Virupaksha temple located ?

- (a) Bhadrachalam
- (b) Chidambaram
- (c) Hampi**
- (d) Srikalahasti

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2009

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q37. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists :

List I (Famous Temple) List II (State)

A. Vidyashankara temple

1. Andhra Pradesh

B. Rajarani temple

2. Karnataka

C. Kandariya Mahadeo temple

3. Madhya Pradesh

D. Bhimesvara temple

4. Orissa

Code :

A B C D

- (a) 2 4 3 1**
- (b) 2 3 4 1
- (c) 1 4 3 2
- (d) 1 3 4 2

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2009

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q54. Who of the following is the author of a collection of poems called "Golden Threshold"?

- (a) Aruna Asaf Ali
- (b) Annie Besant
- (c) Sarojini Naidu**
- (d) Vijayalakshmi Pandit

Answer: (c)

Q57. Anekāntavāda is a core theory and philosophy**of which one of the following?**

- (a) Buddhism
- (b) Jainism**
- (c) Sikhism
- (d) Vaishnavism

Answer: (b)**Q93. Consider the following statements :**

- 1. The National School of Drama was set up by Sangeet Natak Akademi in 1959.**
- 2. The highest honour conferred by the Sahitya Akademi on a writer is by electing him its Fellow.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2**
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)**Q110. Consider the following houses:**

- 1. Christie's**
- 2. Osian's**
- 3. Sotheby's**

Which of the above is/are auctioneer/auctioneers ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2009

Art & Culture › Painting & Visual Arts

moderate

Q144. Consider the following famous names:

1. Amrita Sher-Gil
2. Bikash Bhattacharjee
3. N. S. Bendre
4. Subodh Gupta

Who of the above is/are well known as artist(s)?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 4 only
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4**

Answer: (d)

— 2008 —

UPSC 2008

Art & Culture › Cultural Institutions & Awards

moderate

Q16. Consider the following statements:

1. Orange Prize is awarded to a work of published fiction in English by a woman.
2. Pulitzer Prize is awarded by the Commonwealth Foundation to a citizen of any Commonwealth country for any literary work in English.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2008

Art & Culture › Cultural Institutions & Awards

easy

Q17. Recently, the manuscripts

of which one of the following have been included in the UNESCO's Memory of World Register?

- (a) Abhidhamma Pitaka
- (b) Mahabharata
- (c) Ramayana
- (d) Rig-Veda**

Answer: (d)

Q68. Ebrahim Alkazi is an eminent personality

in which one of the following areas?

- (a) Heart surgery
- (b) Civil aviation
- (c) Theatre training**
- (d) Transport engineering

Answer: (c)

Q70. Bimbavati Devi is a well-known dancer of which type of dance?

- (a) Manipuri**
- (b) Bharat Natyam
- (c) Kuchipudi
- (d) Odissi

Answer: (a)

Q73. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the Lists:

List-I (Author)

- A. Bankimchandra**
- B. Dinabandhu Mitra**
- C. Premchand**

List-II (Work)

- 1. Shatranj Ke Khilari**
- 2. Debi Chaudhurani**
- 3. Nil-Darpan**
- 4. Chandrakanta**

- (a) A-2 B-4 C-1
- (b) A-3 B-4 C-2
- (c) A-2 B-3 C-1**
- (d) A-3 B-1 C-4

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2008

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

moderate

Q76. Among the Indian languages, which one is spoken maximum in the world after Hindi?

- (a) Telugu
- (b) Tamil
- (c) Bengali**
- (d) Malayalam

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2008

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q80. Near

which one of the following cities are Palitana Temples located?

- (a) Bhavnagar**
- (b) Mount Abu
- (c) Nasik
- (d) Ujjain

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2008

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

moderate

Q108. Who among the following translated the Autobiography of Madam Curie in Hindi?

- (a) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
- (b) Lal Bahadur Shastri**
- (c) Choudhary Charan Singh
- (d) Gobind Vallabh Pant

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2008

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q125. Who among the following wrote the poem, Subh-e Azadi?

- (a) Sahir Ludhianvi
- (b) Faiz Ahmed Faiz**
- (c) Muhammad Iqbal
- (d) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad

Answer: (b)

— 2007 —

Q1. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List-I (Person)

- A. Bhajan Sopori**
- B. Birju Maharaj**
- C. Priyadarshini Govind**
- D. T V Gopalkrishnan**

List-II (Known as)

- 1. Bharatanatyam Dancer**
- 2. Exponent of Santoor**
- 3. Mridangam Maestro**
- 4. Kathak Dancer**

Codes:

- (a) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3
- (b) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2
- (c) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3**
- (d) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2

Answer: (c)

Q5. Who among the following wrote the book "Ayodhya : 6 December 1992"?

- (a) Chandra Shekar
- (b) P. V. Narasimha Rao**

- (c) Jaswant Singh
- (d) Arun Shourie

Answer: (b)

Q7. How is Gabriel García well known?

- (a) Known for research in agriculture
- (b) A renowned football coach
- (c) A great writer who won the Nobel Prize for Literature**
- (d) Known for research in railway engineering

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2007

Art & Culture › Cultural Institutions & Awards

easy

Q9. The Pulitzer Prize is associated with

which one of the following?

- (a) Environmental protection
- (b) Civil aviation
- (c) Journalism**
- (d) Olympic Games

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2007

Art & Culture › Painting & Visual Arts

easy

Q10. Raghu Rai is well known

for which one of the following areas?

- (a) Environment protection
- (b) Olympic Games
- (c) Journalism**
- (d) Civil aviation

Answer: (c)

Q11. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List-I (Eminent Person)

- A. Bhanu Bharti**
- B. Mike Pandey**
- C. Mohd. Zafar Khayyam**
- D. Vinda Karandikar**

List-II (Known as)

- 1. Music composer**
- 2. Poet and litterateur**
- 3. Theatre director**
- 4. Wildlife film-maker**

Codes:

- (a) A-1 B-4 C-3 D-2
- (b) A-3 B-2 C-1 D-4
- (c) A-2 B-3 C-4 D-1
- (d) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2**

Answer: (d)

Q13. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List-I (Writer)

A.

V. S. Naipaul

B. Salman Rushdie

C. Paul Scott

D. J. G. Farrell

List-II (Book)

1. The Siege of Krishnapur

2. In a Free State

3. Midnight's Children

4. Staying On

Codes:

(a) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3

(b) A-4 B-3 C-1 D-2

(c) A-3 B-1 C-2 D-4

(d) A-2 B-3 C-4 D-1

Answer: (d)

Q28. For which one of the following books did Kiran Desai win the Man Booker Prize 2006?

(a) The Secret River

(b) In the Country of Men

(c) The Inheritance of Loss

(d) Mother's Milk

Answer: (c)

Q54. Where is the famous Vijaya Vittala Temple having its 56 carved pillars emitting musical notes located?

(a) Belur

(b) Bhadrachalam

(c) Hampi

(d) Srirangam

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2006

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q3. Match List – I with List – II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List – I (Place of Archaeological Monument)

- A. Sisupalgarh
- B. Piprahwa
- C. Goalpara
- D. Bishnupur

List – II (State)

- 1. Assam
- 2. Manipur
- 3. Orissa
- 4. Uttar Pradesh

Code: A B C D

- (a) 4 1 3 2
- (b) 1 2 3 4
- (c) 3 4 1 2**
- (d) 1 3 2 4

Answer: (c)

Q11. Match List – I with List – II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List – I (Centre of Handicrafts)

- A. Mon
- B. Nalbari
- C. Pasighat
- D. Tura

List – II (State)

- 1. Arunachal Pradesh
- 2. Assam
- 3. Meghalaya
- 4. Nagaland

Code: A B C D

- (a) 4 2 1 3
- (b) 4 3 2 1
- (c) 1 3 4 2
- (d) 1 2 4 3

Answer: (a)

Q12. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- (a) Vikramsila Monastery : Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Hemkund Gurudwara : Himachal Pradesh
- (c) Udayagiri Caves : Maharashtra
- (d) Amaravati Buddhist Stupa : Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (d)

Q32. Who among the following is a Hindustani classical singer?

- (a) Geeta Chandran
- (b) Leela Samson
- (c) Gangubai Hangal
- (d) Swapnasundari

Answer: (c)

Q39. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

Prominent Indian Writer : Language

- (a) Raja Rao : Telugu**
- (b) Gobind Trimbuk Deshpande : Marathi
- (c) Subramaniam Bharati : Tamil
- (d) Tara Shankar Joshi : Gujarati

Answer: (a)

Q44. Match List – I with List – II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List – I (Author)

- A. Amartya Sen**
- B. Bimal Jalan**
- C. Arundhati Roy**
- D. Mani Shankar**

List – II (Book)

- 1. An Ordinary Person's Guide to Empire**
- 2. The Argumentative Indian**
- 3. The Future of India**
- 4. Confessions of a Secular Fundamentalist**

Code:

- (a) A 3 B 2 C 1 D 4
- (b) A 3 B 2 C 4 D 1
- (c) A 2 B 3 C 1 D 4**
- (d) A 2 B 3 C 4 D 1

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2006

Art & Culture › Cultural Institutions & Awards

moderate

Q53. Who among the following was presented with the Sangeet Natak Akademi Ratna Award, 2005 for her lifetime achievement in dance?

- (a) **Chandralekha**
- (b) Tanjavur Balasaraswati
- (c) Uma Sharma
- (d) Yamini Krishnamurthy

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2006

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q58. Who is Wole Soyinka ?

- (a) A well-known economist
- (b) A well-known football player
- (c) A well-known industrialist owning steel plants in many parts of the world.
- (d) **A Nobel Prize winner for literature.**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2006

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q66. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

Monastery — State

- (a) Dhankar Monastery — Himachal Pradesh
- (b) Rumtek Monastery — Sikkim
- (c) Tabo Monastery — Himachal Pradesh
- (d) **Kye Monastery — Arunachal Pradesh**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2006

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q75. Bhakta Tukaram was a contemporary of which Mughal Emperor?

- (a) Babar
- (b) Akbar
- (c) **Jahangir**
- (d) Aurangzeb

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2006

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q81. The initial design and construction of which massive temple took place during the reign of Suryavarman II?

- (a) Sri Mariamman Temple
- (b) Angkor Vat**
- (c) Batu Caves Temple
- (d) Kamakhya Temple

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2006

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q82. Indian Airlines (now renamed 'Indian') have redesigned their logo which is a graphic wheel. This logo has been inspired

from which one of the following?

- (a) Hampi Temples
- (b) Mamallapuram Temples
- (c) Sun Temple, Konark**
- (d) Khajuraho Temple

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2006

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q138. "Lectures from Colombo to Almora" is based on the experiences

of which one of the following?

- (a) Veer Savarkar
- (b) Annie Besant
- (c) Ramkrishna Paramhansa
- (d) Swami Vivekanand**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2006

Art & Culture › Theatre & Cinema

easy

Q149. In which one of the following films did the Nobel Laureate Pearl S. Buck collaborate?

- (a) Shatranj Ke Khilari
- (b) Guide**
- (c) Lawrence of Arabia
- (d) Titanic

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2005

Art & Culture › Cultural Institutions & Awards

easy

Q11. Who among the following is not a recipient of the Bharat Ratna Award?

- (a) Ustad Bismillah Khan
- (b) Satyajit Ray
- (c) Lata Mangeshkar
- (d) Raj Kapoor**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2005

Art & Culture › Music

easy

Q28. Whose autobiography is the book "My Music, My Life"?

- (a) Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma
- (b) Ustad Amjad Ali Khan
- (c) Pandit Ravi Shankar**
- (d) Ustad Zakir Hussain

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2005

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q39. Consider the following statements:

- 1. Champaner - Pavagadh Archaeological Park**
- 2. Chhatrapati Shivaji Railway Station, Mumbai**
- 3. Mamallapuram**
- 4. Sun Temple (Konark Temple)**

Which of the above are included in the World Heritage List of UNESCO?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
- (b) 1, 3 and 4
- (c) 2 and 4
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4**

Answer: (d)

— 2004 —

UPSC 2004

Art & Culture › Cultural Institutions & Awards

easy

Q6. The Archaeological Survey of India is an attached office of the Department/Ministry of

- (a) Culture**
- (b) Tourism
- (c) Science and Technology
- (d) Human Resource Development

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2004

Art & Culture › Tribes & Communities

easy

Q14. In which one of the following Union Territories, do the people of the Onge tribe live?

- (a) Andaman & Nicobar Islands**
- (b) Dadra & Nagar Haveli
- (c) Daman & Diu
- (d) Lakshadweep

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2004

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q27. Which one of the following four Vedas contains an account of magical charms and spells?

- (a) Rig-veda
- (b) Yajur-veda
- (c) Atharva-veda**
- (d) Sama-veda

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2004

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

moderate

Q30. Which one of the following sequences indicates the correct chronological order?

- (a) Shankaracharya - Ramanuja - Chaitanya**
- (b) Ramanuja - Shankaracharya - Chaitanya
- (c) Ramanuja - Chaitanya - Shankaracharya
- (d) Shankaracharya - Chaitanya - Ramanuja

Answer: (a)

Q37. Match List I (Books) with List II (Authors) and select the correct answer using the codes given below:

List I

- A. My Presidential Years**
- B. The Hindu View of Life**
- C. Voice of Conscience**
- D. Without Fear or Favour**

List II

- 1. S. Radhakrishnan**
- 2.**
- V. V. Giri**
- 3. N. Sanjiva Reddy**
- 4. R. Venkataraman**

- (a) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3
- (b) A-4 B-3 C-2 D-1
- (c) A-2 B-3 C-4 D-1
- (d) A-4 B-1 C-2 D-3**

Answer: (d)

Q44. Who among the following is well known as an exponent of flute?

- (a) Debu Choudhri
- (b) Madhup Mudgal
- (c) Ronu Mazumdar**
- (d) Shafaat Ahmad

Answer: (c)

Q49. Consider the following statements:

1. Hema Malini is the Chairperson of the Children's Film Society, India.
2. Yash Chopra is the Chairperson of the Central Board of Film Certification of India.
3. Dilip Kumar, Raj Kapoor and Dev Anand have all been recipients of the Dada Saheb Phalke Award.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 2 only
- (d) 3 only**

Answer: (d)

Q67. Consider the following statements:

1. The Islamic Calendar is twelve days shorter than the Gregorian Calendar
2. The Islamic Calendar began in AD 632
3. The Gregorian Calendar is a solar calendar

Which of these statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) 3 only**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2004

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q94. Consider the following international language

1. Arabic
2. French
3. Spanish

The correct sequence of the language given above in the decreasing order of the number of their speakers is

- (a) 3-1-2**
- (b) 1-3-2
- (c) 3-2-1
- (d) 1-2-3

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2004

Art & Culture › Cultural Institutions & Awards

easy

Q114. Which of the following authors won the Booker Prize twice?

- (a) Margaret Atwood
- (b) J. M. Coetzee**
- (c) Graham Swift
- (d) Ian McEwan

Answer: (b)

— 2003 —

UPSC 2003

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q42. 'Mrichchhakatika' an ancient Indian book written by Shudraka deals with

- (a) The love affair of a rich merchant with the daughter of a courtesan**
- (b) The victory of Chandragupta II over the Shaka Kshatrapas of western India
- (c) The military expeditions and exploits of Samudragupta
- (d) The love affair between a Gupta King and a princess of Kamarupa

Answer: (a)

Q47. Which one of the following statements is correct?

(a) The National Song Vande Mataram was composed by Bankimchandra Chatterji originally in Bengali

(b) The National Calendar of India based on Saka era has its 1st Chaitra on 22nd March normally and 21st March in a leap year

(c) The design of the National Flag of India was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on 22nd July 1947

(d) The song 'Jana-gana-mana', composed originally in Bengali by Rabindranath Tagore was adopted in its Hindi version by the Constituent Assembly on 24th January 1950 as the National Anthem of India

Answer: (a)

Q60. Who among the following was selected for the 2001 Dada Saheb Phalke Award?

(a) Dev Anand

(b) Lata Mangeshkar

(c) Ramanand Sagar

(d) Yash Chopra

Answer: (d)

Q95. Dilip Kaur Tiwana is well known as a

(a) litterateur

(b) musician

(c) scientist

(d) sports person

Answer: (a)

Q119. Consider the following

statement:

1. Kitab-I-Nauras, a collection of songs in praise of Hindu deities and Muslim saints, was written by Ibrahim Adil Shah II

2. Amir Khusrau was the originator in India of the early form of the musical style known as Qawwali.

Which of these statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2**
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

— 2002 —

Q16. Which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) The statue of Gomateshwara at Sravanabelagola represents the last Tirthankara of Jains**
- (b) India's largest Buddhist monastery is in Arunachal Pradesh
- (c) The Khajuraho temples were built under Chandela Kings
- (d) The Hoysalesvara temple is dedicated to Siva

Answer: (a)

Q19. In ancient Indian Buddhist monasteries, a ceremony called Pavarana used to be held. It was the

- (a) occasion to elect the Sanghaparinyaka and two speakers, one on Dhamma and the other on Vinaya
- (b) confession by monks of their offences committed during their stay in the monasteries during the rainy season**
- (c) ceremony of initiation of new person into the Buddhist Sangha in which the head is shaved and when yellow robes are offered
- (d) gathering of Buddhist monks on the next day to the full-moon day of Ashadha when they take up a fixed abode for the next four months or rainy season

Answer: (b)

Q40. Match List I (Artist) with List II (Art) and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List I (Artist) List II (Art)

A. Hiren Bhattacharya

1. Bharatanatyam dance

B. Malini Rajurkar

2. Hindustani vocal music

C. Pratibha Prahlad

3. Kuchipudi dance

D. Vempati Chinna Satyam

4. Puppetry

Codes:

A B C D

(a) 4 2 1 3

(b) 3 1 2 4

(c) 4 1 2 3

(d) 3 2 1 4

Answer: (a)

Q48. Who was the first Indian actress to receive the Padma Shri Award?

(a) Smita Patil

(b) Nargis Dutt

(c) Meena Kumari

(d) Madhubala

Answer: (b)

Q86. Match List I (Book) with List II (Author) and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List I (Book)

List II (Author)

A. Autobiography of an Unknown Indian

1. Mulk Raj Anand

B. India: A Wounded Civilization

2. Nirad

C. Chaudhuri

C. Confessions of a Lover

3. R. K. Narayan

D. The English Teacher

4.

V. S. Naipaul

Codes:

(a) 1 3 2 4

(b) 2 4 1 3

(c) 1 4 2 3

(d) 2 3 1 4

Answer: (b)

Q108. Chapchar Kut is a festival celebrated in the state of

(a) Arunachal Pradesh

(b) Assam

(c) Mizoram

(d) Sikkim

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2001

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q5. In which one of the following cities is the Lingaraja Temple located?

- (a) Bhubaneswar**
- (b) Bijapur
- (c) Kolkata
- (d) Shravanabelagola

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2001

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q17. Who amongst the following Englishmen first translated the Bhagavad-Gita into English?

- (a) William Jones
- (b) Charles Wilkins**
- (c) Alexander Cunningham
- (d) John Marshall

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2001

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q58. Hoysala monuments are found in

- (a) Hampi and Hospet
- (b) Halebid and Belur**
- (c) Mysore and Bangalore
- (d) Sringeri and Dharwar

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2001

Art & Culture › Theatre & Cinema

easy

Q65. Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

- (a) India's first Technicolour film — Jhansi Ki Rani
- (b) India's first 3-D film — My Dear Kuttichat
- (c) India's first insured film — Taal
- (d) India's first actress to win the Bharat Ratna — Meena Kumari**

Answer: (d)

Q66. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I (Dancer)

I. Kalamandalam Kshemavaty

II. Kottakkal Sivaraman

III. Lakshmi Viswanathan

IV. N. Madhabi Devi

List II (Dance)

A) Kathakali

B) Manipuri

C) Mohiniyattam

D) Bharata Natyam

(a) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

(b) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

(c) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

(d) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Answer: (b)

Q87. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

(a) Harappan Civilisation ... Painted Grey Ware

(b) The Kushans ... Gandhara School of Art

(c) The Mughals ... Ajanta Paintings

(d) The Marathas ... Pahari School of Painting

Answer: (b)

— 2000 —

Q21. The Raga which is sung early in the morning is

(a) Todi

(b) Darbari

(c) Bhopali

(d) Bhimpalasi

Answer: (a)

Q27. Consider the following statements regarding the Chakiarkoothu form of dance:

I. It is performed by Chakiar caste.

II. It cannot be traditionally witnessed by the higher caste Hindus.

III. Mizhavu is the accompanying instrument.

IV. Its theatre form is called koothambalam.

Which of these statements are correct?

(a) I, III and IV

(b) I, II and III

(c) II, III and IV

(d) I, II and IV

Answer: (a)

Q31. Match List I (Books) with List II (Authors)

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I

I. My Music, My Life

II. Adha Gaon

III. Radha

IV. The Pilferer

List II

A) Laxman Gaikwad

B) Rahi Masoom Raza

C) Ramakanta Rath

D) Ravi Shankar

Codes:

(a) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

(b) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

(c) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

(d) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Answer: (b)

Q40. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I (Artist)

I. Balamurali Krishna

II. Mita Pandit

III. Kanyakumari

IV. Nikhil Bannerjee

List II (Medium of music delivery)

A) Hindustani vocal

B) Ghatam

C) Sitar

D) Violin

E) Carnatic vocal

Codes:

(a) I-E, II-A, III-B, IV-C

(b) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-E

(c) I-C, II-A, III-E, IV-B

(d) I-E, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Answer: (a)

Q66. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

(a) Baki Itihas: Badal Sarkar

(b) Sita Swayamvar: Vishnu Das Bhave

(c) Yayati: Girish Karnad

(d) Giddha: Jabbar Patel

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2000

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

moderate

Q85. Assertion (A): The Aham and Puram poems of the Padinen Kilukanakku group formed a continuation of the Sangam composition.

Reason (R): They were included under the Post-Sangam works as against the Sangam works proper.

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A**
- (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not a correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true, but R is false
- (d) A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)

— 1999 —

UPSC 1999

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q15. Consider the following statements: The striking feature of the Jama Masjid in Kashmir completed by Zain-ul-Abidin include(s)

I. Turret.

II. Similarity with Buddhist pagodas.

III. Persian style.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) I alone
- (b) I, II and III**
- (c) II and III
- (d) I and III

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1999

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q33. The first writer to use Urdu as the medium of poetic expression was

- (a) Amir Khusru**
- (b) Mirza Ghalib
- (c) Bahadur Shah Zafar
- (d) Faiz

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1999

Art & Culture › Painting & Visual Arts

easy

Q37. The paintings of Abanindranath Tagore are classified as

- (a) realistic
- (b) socialistic
- (c) revivalistic**
- (d) impressionistic

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1999

Art & Culture › Music

difficult

Q41. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I

I. Pandit Vishnu Digamber Paluskar

II. Venkatamahi

III. Shyama Shastri

IV. Amir Khusru

List II

A. Introduced the scheme of Raga classification of Indian music

B. Proponent of Carnatic music

C. Proponent of the Khayal form of Hindustani music

D. Wrote the music for the song 'Vande Mataram'

Codes:

- (a) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (b) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C**
- (c) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (d) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1999

Art & Culture › Theatre & Cinema

easy

Q45. The first feature film (talkie) to be produced in India was

- (a) Hatimtai
- (b) Alam Ara**
- (c) Pundalik
- (d) Raja Harishchandra

Answer: (b)

Q48. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I (Libraries)

I. Saraswati Mahal Library

II. Library of Tibetan Work and Archives

III. Raza Library

IV. Khuda Baksh Oriental Public Library

List II (Locations)

A. Patna

B. Dharamsala

C. Thanjavur

D. Rampur

Codes:

(a) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

(b) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

(c) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D

(d) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Answer: (a)

Q74. Which one of the following pairs of folk-dance forms and states is not correctly matched?

(a) Korku : Maharashtra

(b) Jhummar : Haryana

(c) Thali : Himachal Pradesh

(d) Mukna : Manipur

Answer: (a)

Q88. Which one of the following statements is correct?

(a) 'Neel Darpan' was a play based on the exploitation of the indigo farmers

(b) The author of the play 'Ghashiram Kotwal' is Vijay Tendulkar

(c) The play 'Navanna' by Nabin Chandra Das was based on the famine of Bengal

(d) Urdu theatre used to depend heavily on Parsi theatre

Answer: (d)

Q90. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I (Writers)

I. Sashi Tharoor

II. Amitav Ghosh

III. Anita Desai

IV. Vikram Chandra

List II (Books)

A) Clear Light of Day

B) Circle of Reason

C) Love and Longing in Bombay

D) Show Business

(a) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

(b) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

(c) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

(d) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Answer: (a)

Q92. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I (Books)

I. The First Indian War of Independence

II. Anand Math

III. Life Divine

IV. Sadhana

List II (Authors)

A) Rabindranath Tagore

B) Sri Aurobindo

C) Bankim Chandra Chatterji

D) Vinayak Damodar Savarkar

(a) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

(b) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

(c) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

(d) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Answer: (a)

— 1998 —

Q21. Which one of the following languages belongs to the Austric group?

(a) Marathi

(b) Ladakhi

(c) Khasi

(d) Tamil

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1998

Art & Culture › Sculpture & Iconography

moderate

Q26. Assertion (A): The Gandhara School of art bears the mark of Hellenistic influence.

Reason (R): Hinayana form was influenced by that art.

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (b) Both A and R are true, but R is NOT a correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true, but R is false**
- (d) A is false, but R is true

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1998

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q36. Which of the following pairs are correctly matched?

I. Lothal: Ancient dockyard

II. Sarnath: First Sermon of Buddha

III. Rajgir: Lion capital of Asoka

IV. Nalanda: Great seat of Buddhist learning

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

Codes:

- (a) I, II, III and IV
- (b) III and IV
- (c) I, II and IV**
- (d) I and II

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1998

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q45. The concept of Eight-fold path forms the theme of

- (a) Dipavamsa
- (b) Divyavadana
- (c) Mahaparinibbana Sutta
- (d) Dharma Chakka Pravartana Sutta**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1998

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q60. Many of the Greeks, Kushanas and Shakas embraced Buddhism rather than Hinduism because

- (a) Buddhism was in the ascendant at that time
- (b) They had renounced the policy of war and violence
- (c) Caste-ridden Hinduism did not attract them
- (d) Buddhism provided easier access to Indian society**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1998

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

moderate

Q71. Which of the following pairs are correctly matched?

I. Mrichchhakatikam — Shudraka

II. Buddhacharita — Vasuvandhu

III. Mudrarakshasha — Vishakhadatta

IV. Harshacharita — Banabhatta

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) I, II, III and IV
- (b) I, III and IV**
- (c) I and IV
- (d) II and III

Answer: (b)

— 1997 —

Q42. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer

using the code given below the lists:

List I

I. Gupta

II. Chandella

III. Chalukya

IV. Pallava

List II

A) Badami

B) Panamalai

C) Khajuraho

D) Deogarh

Codes:

(a) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

(b) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

(c) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

(d) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Answer: (a)

Q44. The film 'The Making of the Mahatma' has been directed by

(a) Peter Ustinov

(b) Richard Attenborough

(c) **Shyam Benegal**

(d) Mira Nair

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1997

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

moderate

Q48. Which one of the following statements regarding Asokan stone pillars is incorrect?

- (a) These are highly polished
- (b) These are monolithic
- (c) The shaft of pillars is tapering in shape
- (d) These are parts of architectural structures**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1997

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q52. Which one of the following pairs of composers in different languages and their works on the Mahabharata theme is correctly matched?

- (a) Sarladasa — Bengali
- (b) Kasirama — Oriya
- (c) Tikkana — Marathi
- (d) Pampa — Kannada**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1997

Art & Culture › Classical Dance Forms

easy

Q59. Which one of the following dances involves solo performance?

- (a) Bharatnatyam**
- (b) Kuchipudi
- (c) Mohiniattam
- (d) Odissi

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1997

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q62. Which one of the following scripts of ancient India was written from right to left?

- (a) Brahmi
- (b) Nandnagari
- (c) Sharada
- (d) Kharosthi**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1997

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q73. The famous dialogue between Nachiketa and Yama is mentioned in the

- (a) Chandogyopanishad
- (b) Mundakopanishad
- (c) Kathopanishad**
- (d) Kenopanishad

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1997

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q77. Milindapanho is in the form of a dialogue between the King Menander and the Buddhist monk

- (a) Nagasena**
- (b) Nagarjuna
- (c) Nagabhatta
- (d) Kumarilabhatta

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1997

Art & Culture › Sculpture & Iconography

easy

Q86. In the Mahayana Buddhism, the Bodhisattva Avalokitesvara was also known as

- (a) Vajrapani
- (b) Manjusri
- (c) Padmapani**
- (d) Maitreya

Answer: (c)

Q94. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer by using the codes given below the lists:

List I (Author)

I. Varahamihira

II. Visakhadatta

III. Sudraka

IV. Bilhana

List II (Text)

A) Prabandha Chintamani

B) Mrchchhakatikam

C) Brhat-Samhita

D) Devi Chandraguptam

E) Vikramankadevacharita

Codes:

- (a) I-C, II-D, III-E, IV-B
- (b) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-E**
- (c) I-E, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (d) I-A, II-C, III-E, IV-B

Answer: (b)

— 1996 —

Q5. Prem Vatika, poems on the life of Krishna, was composed by

- (a) Bihari
- (b) Surdas
- (c) Raskhan**
- (d) Kabir

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q8. Which one of the following works has recently been made into a full-length feature film?

- (a) R. K. Narayan's *Malgudi Days*
- (b) Salman Rushdie's *Midnight's Children*
- (c) Vikram Seth's *A Suitable Boy*
- (d) Upamanyu Chatterjee's *English August***

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q15. Which one of the following is an important historical novel written during the latter half of the nineteenth century?

- (a) *Rast Goftar*
- (b) *Durgesh Nandini***
- (c) *Maharatha*
- (d) *Nibandhamala*

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q18. According to ancient Indian cosmogonic ideas the sequential order of the cycle of four aeons (Yugas) is

- (a) *Dvapara, Krita, Treta and Kali*
- (b) *Krita, Dvapara, Treta and Kali*
- (c) *Krita, Treta, Dvapara and Kali***
- (d) *Treta, Dvapara, Kali and Krita*

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Festivals, Crafts & Folk Traditions

moderate

Q25. Which one of the following temples figured in the news regarding the institution of the Devadasis?

- (a) *Jagannath temple, Puri***
- (b) *Pasupatinath temple, Kathmandu*
- (c) *Kandariya Mahadeva temple, Khajuraho*
- (d) *Chausanth Yogini temple, Bheraghat*

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

moderate

Q32. Which one of the following is not a part of early Jaina literature?

- (a) Therigatha**
- (b) Acarangasutra
- (c) Sutrakritanga
- (d) Brihatkalpasutra

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

moderate

Q35. Which of the following were common to both Buddhism and Jainism?

I. Avoidance of extremities of penance and enjoyment.

II. Indifference to the authority of the Vedas

III. Denial of efficacy of rituals

IV. Non-injury to animal life

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) I, II, III and IV
- (b) II, III and IV**
- (c) I, III and IV
- (d) I and II

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Scripts & Calligraphy

easy

Q44. Nastaliq was

- (a) a Persian script used in medieval India**
- (b) a raga composed by Tansen
- (c) a cess levied by the Mughal rulers
- (d) a manual of code of conduct for the Ulemas

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Sculpture & Iconography

easy

Q53. Which one of the following sculptures invariably used green schist as the medium?

- (a) Maurya sculptures
- (b) Mathura sculptures
- (c) Bharhut sculptures
- (d) Gandhara sculptures**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Painting & Visual Arts

easy

Q61. Mughal painting reached its zenith under

- (a) Humayun
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Jahangir**
- (d) Shahjahan

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

easy

Q66. The term apabhramsa was used in medieval Sanskrit texts to denote

- (a) outcastes among the Rajputs
- (b) deviations from Vedic rituals
- (c) early forms of some of the modern Indian languages**
- (d) non-Sanskrit verse metres

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

difficult

Q71. Which one of the following was a Saiva sect in ancient India?

- (a) Ajivika
- (b) Mattamayura**
- (c) Mayamata
- (d) Isanasivagurudevapaddhati

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Literature & Languages

moderate

Q79. Which one of the following texts of ancient India allows divorce to a wife deserted by her husband?

- (a) Kamasutra
- (b) Manavadharmashastra
- (c) Sukra Nitisara
- (d) Arthashastra**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Performing Arts

medium

Q83. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- (a) Naqqal — Bihar
- (b) Tamasha — Orissa
- (c) Ankia Nat — Assam**
- (d) Baha — Punjab

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q92. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- (a) Guru Amar Das ... Miri and Piri
- (b) Guru Arjan Dev ... Adi Granth**
- (c) Guru Ram Das ... Dal Khalsa
- (d) Guru Gobind Singh ... Manji

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1996

Art & Culture › Theatre & Cinema

easy

Q94. The following advertisement appeared in the Times of India dated 7th August:

"THE MARVEL OF THE CENTURY

THE WONDER OF THE WORLD

**LIVING PHOTOGRAPHIC PICTURES IN LIFE-SIZED REPRODUCTIONS BY MESSERS LUMIERE
BROTHERS CINEMATOGRAPHIE**

A FEW EXHIBITIONS WILL BE GIVEN AT WATSON'S HOTEL TONIGHT".

It appeared in the year —

- (a) 1931
- (b) 1929
- (c) 1921
- (d) 1896**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1995

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q2. The word 'Hindu' as reference to the people of Hind (India) was first used by

- (a) the Greeks
- (b) the Romans
- (c) the Chinese
- (d) the Arabs**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1995

Art & Culture › Tribes & Communities

easy

Q14. The original home of the gypsies was

- (a) Egypt
- (b) Russia
- (c) India**
- (d) Persia

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1995

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q24. The Nagara, the Dravida and the Vesara are

- (a) the three main racial groups of the Indian subcontinent
- (b) the three main linguistic divisions into which the languages of India can be classified
- (c) the three main styles of Indian temple architecture**
- (d) the three main musical gharanas of Indian classical music

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1995

Art & Culture › Painting & Visual Arts

easy

Q33. The Mughal School of Painting formed the spinal column of the various schools of Indian miniature art.

Which one of the following painting styles was not affected by Mughal painting?

- (a) Pahari
- (b) Rajasthani
- (c) Kangra
- (d) Kalighata**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1995

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

moderate

Q42. According to the Mimamsa system of philosophy, liberation is possible by means of

- (a) Jnana
- (b) Bhakti
- (c) Yoga
- (d) Karma**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1995

Art & Culture › Theatre & Cinema

easy

Q43. The lead character in the film The Bandit Queen has been played by

- (a) Pratibha Sinha
- (b) Rupa Ganguly
- (c) Seema Biswas**
- (d) Shabana Azmi

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1995

Art & Culture › Sculpture & Iconography

easy

Q52. Bronze icons of Nataraja cast during the Chola period invariably show the deity with

- (a) eight hands
- (b) six hands
- (c) four hands**
- (d) two hands

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1995

Art & Culture › Architecture & World Heritage

easy

Q58. Which one of the following monuments has a dome which is said to be one of the largest in the world?

- (a) Tomb of Sher Shah, Sasaram
- (b) Jama Masjid, Delhi
- (c) Tomb of Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq, Delhi
- (d) Gol Gumbaz, Bijapur**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1995

Art & Culture › Philosophy & Religion

easy

Q88. 88. The concept of Anuvrata was advocated by

- (a) Mahayana Buddhism
- (b) Hinayana Buddhism
- (c) Jainism**
- (d) the Lokayata school

Answer: (c)